

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Permit issued to raze Damen Silos

Former grain storage units in McKinley Park will come down despite neighbors' efforts toward deal

By Lily Carey
Chicago Tribune

The Chicago Department of Buildings issued a permit Thursday for the demolition of the iconic Damen Silos, a relic of the Lower West Side's once-prominent grain processing industry. A demolition

date is expected to be announced next week.

Neighbors of the site launched a last-ditch effort to preserve the silos and asked the new owner, MAT Limited Partnership, to consider revamping the former silos as a public festival space. However, negotiations fell

through. The demolition process will last approximately six months and MAT is contracting with Heneghan Wrecking Co.

The Damen Silos, at 2900 S. Damen Ave., were once used as grain storage facilities. Since ceasing operations in 1977, the silos have sat vacant for nearly 50 years. They're located in the McKinley Park neighborhood on the Lower West Side, an area designated by the city as an "environmental

justice neighborhood" that has been overburdened by pollution.

In late 2022, the state sold the Damen Silos for \$6.5 million to the highest bidder, MAT Limited Partnership, a group of South Side companies run by business owner Michael Tadin Jr. The company has not released plans for what they'll be using the site for after its demolition.

But neighbors have raised concerns about whether the

company will handle demolition in a safe and environmentally conscious way. The company also operates MAT Asphalt, a controversial hot asphalt mixing plant located about a mile south of the silos at 2033 W. Pershing Road. The state didn't hold any public meetings before issuing a construction permit for the plant in 2018.

"Literally, by the time we found

Turn to Silos, Page 2

Trump's orders to get harder to fight

Supreme Court ruling could stretch resources of Illinois AG office

By Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

A Supreme Court decision limiting federal judges from issuing nationwide injunctions is expected to make it more difficult for blue states fighting President Donald Trump's executive orders to get widespread relief and could further stretch the resources of Illinois' attorney general's office as it pushes back against the administration.

For Americans opposed to Trump administration actions that include funding cuts and immigration matters, "it creates a greater reliance on your state to take action for you, your state attorneys general," Attorney General Kwame Raoul in an interview, "because it's harder to get broad protection as an individual."

Since the start of the Trump administration, Raoul and other mostly blue state attorneys general have filed dozens of lawsuits against Trump's actions in federal courts, some of which led to nationwide injunctions blocking the president's orders. The high court's ruling has limited those injunctions.

Illinois has joined more than 20 lawsuits against the Trump administration on issues ranging from funding issues to birthright citizenship.

The court's ruling was a win for Trump, who has said he believes federal judges have overstepped in blocking some of his administration's actions. For those oppos-

Turn to Injunctions, Page 4



DAVID BANKS/AP

Busch leads record homer binge vs. Cards

The Cubs hit a team-record eight home runs — led by three from Michael Busch, above, and two from Pete-Crow Armstrong — in rolling to an 11-3 win over the Cardinals at Wrigley Field. **Chicago Sports**

Boy dies, others are hurt in stabbing, fire

A 4-year-old boy dies after a woman uses a knife to attack multiple people inside a Logan Square apartment before setting the home on fire Friday morning, according to Chicago police. **Chicagoland, Page 4**



AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

FOURTH OF JULY

Head and shoulders above

Theo Searle Ross, 5, and Alex Searle Ross, 3, sit on the shoulders of their father, Justin Searle Ross, while watching performances during the Fourth on 53rd Parade and festival in Hyde Park on Friday.



Dr. Jacqueline Hairston, a maternal-fetal medicine specialist, listens to a pregnant patient during an appointment at Northwestern Memorial Hospital in Chicago on June 24. **JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Program to aid those planning pregnancy amid obesity issues

New Northwestern Medicine initiative helps patients navigate risks

By Katherine Weaver
Chicago Tribune

Northwestern Medicine has launched a program to help patients who have concerns related to obesity and are planning a pregnancy.

Women with higher levels of body fat sometimes struggle to conceive and can face greater

health risks during pregnancy. The PEARL program, which stands for Preconception and Early Assessment Care Rooted in Lifestyle Management, aims to help these patients have safe and healthy pregnancies.

Dr. Christina Boots, a reproductive endocrinology and infertility specialist and one of the clinicians in the program,

estimates that about one-third of her infertility patients struggle with obesity. "There's many more beyond that, who maybe don't meet the criteria for obesity, but are struggling with overweight or insulin resistance and prediabetes or any other metabolic health

Turn to Pregnancy, Page 6

Mrs. O'Leary heirs hoping old clock finds a home

Owners want family relic to stay on display for future generations

By William Lee
Chicago Tribune

The towering grandfather clock in the foyer of Paul and Susan Monreal's soon-to-be former home is far more than a conversation piece. It is a relic from the grand old age of worker's saloons and packed gambling houses — and it involves one of Chicago's most well-known families.

The clock is believed to have once resided in the old South Side mansion built by James "Big Jim" O'Leary, famous gambling boss of the early 20th-century Union Stock Yards area and the son of Catherine O'Leary, the most maligned milkwoman in city history.

Paul Monreal is a fourth-great-grandchild of Catherine and Patrick O'Leary, who endured the enmity of Chicagoans after they were wrongfully accused of starting the Great Chicago Fire, which legend said was started by a jittery dairy cow named Daisy.

Since 1994, the intricately carved, 9-foot-tall behemoth has held court in the entryway of Paul and Susan Monreal's split-level home in New Lenox, where they

Turn to O'Leary, Page 4

